Sikander Bakht

Staff Software Engineer (React Native) | Tech Lead

Lead React Native Engineer with 10+ years building and owning large-scale mobile apps across fintech, banking, and enterprise. Hands-on with React Native and TypeScript using Redux Toolkit, RTK Query, and Hooks, with deep native Android and iOS expertise. I lead architecture, performance, and engineering standards to improve stability, scalability, and release confidence through CI/CD, testing, and profiling.

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SKILLS

React Native | TypeScript | JavaScript | Expo | Redux Toolkit | RTK Query | React Hooks | Android (Kotlin/Java) | iOS (Swift/Obj-C) | Modular Architecture | Clean Architecture | Design Systems | Native Modules (TurboModules/JSI) | Flipper | Android Profiler | Xcode Instruments | CI/CD | GitHub Actions | Gradle | App Security | Encryption/Decryption | Secure Storage | TDD | Jest | UI Automation | WebdriverIO

WORK EXPERIENCE

Staff Software Engineer

Nagarro

04/2022 - Present *Dubai, United Arab Emirates*

Achievements/Tasks

- Accountable for production stability and the mobile technical roadmap , leading the architecture and delivery of enterprise-scale React Native banking applications across multiple squads.
- Designed and led a modular React Native architecture, enabling independently runnable feature modules and reducing Android build times from 40 to 2 minutes.
- Owned and delivered complex end-to-end fintech journeys , including KYC-enabled digital account opening, integrating native SDKs such as Jumio for liveness and ID verification.
- Mentored and guided junior and mid-level mobile engineers , leading code reviews, architectural discussions, and enforcing best practices around performance, security, and maintainability.
- Drove quality and automation initiatives , implementing E2E testing using WebdriverIO and Appium , significantly reducing manual testing effort and regression cycles.
- Led performance and reliability improvements using Flipper, Android Profiler, and Xcode Instruments, reducing over-rendering, improving scroll smoothness, and strengthening app stability across device tiers.

Senior Software Engineer

STC Bahrain

11/2019 - 04/2022 *Manama, Bahrain*

Achievements/Tasks

- Refactored the app into a modular architecture using TypeScript and Redux Toolkit with RTK Query, improving separation of concerns and long-term maintainability.
- Improved production reliability by hardening networking and edge-case handling, helping sustain 99–100% crash-free releases across multiple production cycles.
- Built and scaled complex navigation flows using React Navigation and deep linking, ensuring a seamless user experience across authentication, onboarding, and feature modules.
- Led the launch of NFC Tap & Go payments with Mastercard, integrating their SDK with virtual cards and implementing secure token handling and device binding, delivering the feature within 6 months.
- Contributed to an app that reached 10M+ downloads with a 4.5+ rating on the Play Store by driving stability, code quality, and user-focused features.
- Closely collaborated with product, QA, and backend teams to align on requirements, address integration challenges, and ensure timely feature rollouts.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer
SADAD Bahrain

06/2017 - 11/2019 *Manama, Bahrain*

Achievements/Tasks

- Contributed to the development of a one-stop payment solution, integrating over 200+ services within the mobile application.
- Migrated the app architecture from a monolithic structure to a modular MVVM-inspired pattern in React Native using Redux, React Navigation, and reusable hooks, significantly improving code structure, readability, and maintainability.
- Designed a dynamic, backend-driven UI system that rendered screens based on API responses, significantly reducing development time and code duplication across services.
- Maintained 90%+ unit test coverage and a 99–100% crash-free rate , ensuring high reliability and faster issue detection in production.
- Followed modern development practices and SOLID principles to deliver scalable features with clean, testable code in a high-volume fintech environment.
- Partnered with backend and QA to streamline API rollout and verification, accelerating delivery of new services and reducing integration defects.

EDUCATION

Bachelors of Science - Computer Science
National University of Computer and Emerging Sciences, Lahore

08/2013 - 08/2017 *Lahore, Pakistan*

PROJECTS

Emirates NBD Bank & Liv Digital Bank (04/2023 - Present)

- Led modularization of a large React Native codebase powering 5 white-label banking apps , restructuring into core + feature modules and reducing Android build times from 40 minutes to 2 minutes , enabling parallel squad development.
- Designed independently runnable feature modules with decoupled dependencies and a scalable navigation framework, significantly improving developer velocity and cross-team ownership.
- Built a dedicated digital account opening module from scratch, integrating Jumio KYC & liveness , and supporting backend-driven flows and multi-flavor logic across brands.
- Owned core mobile architecture decisions (Redux Toolkit, TypeScript, Hooks), ensuring consistent UI patterns, predictable state management, and long-term scalability across applications.

Edara by Riyad Bank (04/2022 - 06/2023)

- Led the development of a React Native digital business banking app (iOS & Android), delivering a unified cross-platform experience integrating multiple core banking services.
- Implemented complex lending journeys (mortgage and loans), covering eligibility checks, document capture, validation, and real-time application status tracking under banking compliance constraints.
- Defined a modular React Native architecture with clear separation of concerns, supporting scalability, maintainability, and rapid feature evolution across financial domains.
- Worked closely with product, backend, and QA teams to deliver reliable, secure, and performance-optimized financial workflows aligned with business goals.

STC Pay BH (11/2019 - 04/2022)

- Led the overhaul of Bahrain's leading mobile wallet, migrating to a scalable, modular architecture and improving performance and developer productivity across iOS and Android.
- Delivered key wallet features including NFC Tap & Go , Virtual Cards , and multiple payment integrations (Mastercard, BFC, Fawri/Fawri+), supporting high-volume financial transactions.
- Strengthened application reliability and quality by improving testing practices, error handling, and monitoring, contributing to a consistently high crash-free production experience.
- Collaborated with external partners and internal teams to deliver secure, compliant payment flows in a regulated fintech environment.

Sadad Payment App (06/2017 - 11/2019)

- Integrated 100+ payment services into the Sadad app, collaborating closely with backend teams to build a flexible and scalable payments platform.
- Designed and implemented a Server-Driven UI framework to render dynamic screens from backend configurations, enabling faster feature rollout and reducing the need for frequent app releases.
- Established a modular, MVVM-inspired mobile architecture with clear separation of concerns, improving maintainability and enabling safer evolution of complex payment flows.
- Reduced application size by ~40% through optimized builds, code splitting, and platform-specific configurations, improving app performance and distribution efficiency.